

BAJAJ FINANCE LIMITED

Helpdesk Agent Knowledge Base

Prose Reference Edition — FY 2024–25

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This document is the prose-format reference edition of the Bajaj Finance Helpdesk Knowledge Base. All policy information is presented in descriptive paragraph form to support agent training, onboarding, and the BajajBot AI assistant knowledge base. For structured lookup tables, refer to the companion Policy Reference Document v4.0.

Section 1 — Personal Loan: Eligibility, Rates & Charges

1.1 Who Can Apply for a Bajaj Finance Personal Loan

Bajaj Finance personal loans are designed for both salaried employees and self-employed professionals. However, all eligibility conditions must be satisfied simultaneously — meeting only some of the criteria is not sufficient for approval.

For salaried applicants, the minimum age is 21 years and the maximum is 60 years at the time of application. Self-employed professionals may apply between the ages of 25 and 65 years. The minimum net take-home income required for salaried applicants is Rs 25,000 per month. Self-employed professionals must demonstrate a minimum annual income of Rs 4.8 lakhs as declared in their Income Tax Return.

A CIBIL score of 700 or above is required for standard approval. Applicants with a score between 650 and 699 may be considered under enhanced scrutiny, but approval is not guaranteed. Applicants with a CIBIL score below 650 are automatically rejected by the system and cannot proceed with a personal

loan application.

Salaried applicants must have a minimum of one year of continuous service with their current employer and at least two years of total work experience. Self-employed professionals must have been practising in the same profession for a minimum of three years. Doctors, Chartered Accountants, and Architects are treated as eligible self-employed professionals under this category.

The Fixed Obligation to Income Ratio, commonly referred to as FOIR, must not exceed 50 percent for standard applicants. This means that the total of all existing EMI obligations plus the proposed new loan EMI must not exceed half of the applicant's net monthly income. For government and defence employees, a relaxed FOIR ceiling of 55 percent applies, and the maximum eligible age is extended to 65 years.

Agent Note: Always calculate FOIR before quoting eligibility to a customer. A customer with CIBIL 760 and monthly income of Rs 30,000 but existing EMIs of Rs 18,000 has a FOIR of 60 percent and is ineligible for a new loan despite an excellent credit score. If the sum of existing EMIs and proposed EMI divided by net income exceeds 0.50, the system will automatically reject the application regardless of CIBIL score.

1.2 Interest Rates — How They Are Determined

Interest rates on personal loans at Bajaj Finance are risk-based, meaning they are determined individually for each applicant based on three primary factors: the applicant's CIBIL score, their employment category (salaried or self-employed), and the loan amount requested. All rates quoted below are effective from April 2025.

Salaried applicants with a CIBIL score of 750 or above receive the most favourable interest rates, ranging from 11 percent to 13 percent per annum. These applicants may borrow up to Rs 40 lakhs for a tenure of 12 to 84 months. Self-employed applicants in the same credit score band receive rates between 12 and 14 percent per annum, with a maximum loan amount of Rs 25 lakhs and tenure of 12 to 60 months.

For applicants with a CIBIL score between 700 and 749, salaried borrowers are offered rates from 13 to 16 percent per annum with a maximum loan of Rs 25 lakhs. Self-employed applicants in this bracket are charged between 14 and 17.5 percent per annum and may borrow up to Rs 15 lakhs for up to 48 months.

Applicants with a CIBIL score in the 650 to 699 range are placed in the highest risk bracket. Salaried applicants here face rates between 16 and 20 percent per annum, with a cap of Rs 10 lakhs and a maximum tenure of 36 months. Self-employed applicants in this range are charged between 16 and 22 percent per annum, with a maximum of Rs 7 lakhs for 24 months.

It is important to explain to customers that the exact rate within any given band depends on internal credit assessment and cannot be guaranteed at the inquiry stage. The final rate is communicated in the sanction letter after full underwriting.

1.3 Fees and Charges Explained

Every personal loan at Bajaj Finance carries a processing fee, which ranges from 1.5 to 3.5 percent of the loan amount plus GST, subject to a minimum of Rs 1,999. This fee is deducted upfront from the disbursed amount and is non-refundable even if the loan is cancelled within the cooling-off period.

If an EMI payment is missed or delayed, a late payment charge of 2 percent per month is applied on the overdue EMI amount, starting from day one of the default. This charge compounds monthly and can significantly increase the outstanding amount if not addressed promptly.

When a NACH or ECS auto-debit mandate fails due to insufficient balance in the registered bank account, a bounce charge of Rs 1,000 plus GST is levied per bounce event. This is in addition to any late payment charges that may apply.

Customers who wish to close their loan early have the option of full prepayment. If the loan is closed within the first 12 months, a prepayment penalty of 4 percent of the outstanding principal applies. After 12 months, this penalty reduces to 2 percent of outstanding principal. Part prepayment is permitted only after 12 months, carries a charge of 2 percent, and is capped at 25 percent of the original principal per calendar year.

If a customer decides to cancel the loan after disbursement, cancellation is accepted within 15 days. However, the processing fee paid at the time of disbursement is not refunded. Customers requiring a duplicate No Objection Certificate after loan closure are charged Rs 500 plus GST, and the document is issued within 7 working days. A foreclosure statement can be obtained for Rs 200 plus GST and is available within 2 working days.

Section 2 — Personal Loan: Required Documents

2.1 Identity and Address Proof

All personal loan applicants must provide an Aadhaar Card and a PAN Card as mandatory identity documents. No exceptions are made to this requirement. Additionally, applicants must submit at least one supplementary identity document from the following: Passport or Voter ID.

For address proof, the Aadhaar Card is acceptable if it carries the current address. Alternatively, a utility bill not older than three months or a bank statement not older than three months may be submitted. Two recent passport-size photographs are required. Digital photographs submitted through the Bajaj Finserv mobile application are also acceptable.

2.2 Income Documents for Salaried Employees

Salaried applicants must provide their last three months' salary slips. These slips must carry the employer's stamp. Salary slips generated from the company's HR portal in PDF format are acceptable, provided they are official and unedited. For loans above Rs 10 lakhs, Form 16 for the last two years is mandatory and both years must be submitted together.

Bank statements covering the last six months from the primary salary account are required. All pages must be included with no missing months, as even a single missing month results in an automatic hold on the application. Statements must be downloaded directly from net banking or obtained on bank letterhead.

If the applicant has been with their current employer for less than one year, an employment letter confirming their current position and salary is required. Applicants whose joining date is within the last six months must additionally provide their offer letter.

2.3 Income Documents for Self-Employed Professionals

Self-employed applicants must submit their Income Tax Returns with computation for the last two years. These must be CA certified, filed on time, and show clear income declaration. The Balance Sheet and Profit and Loss statement for the last two years, certified by a Chartered Accountant, are mandatory.

Bank statements covering 12 months from the primary business account must be provided, with all pages intact and on bank letterhead. GST Returns for the last four quarters are required for businesses with annual turnover above Rs 40 lakhs.

Professional certification is required based on the applicant's profession. Doctors must provide their MCI registration certificate, Chartered Accountants must provide their ICAI membership certificate, and Architects must provide their Council of Architecture certificate.

2.4 Additional Requirements for High Loan Amounts

For loan amounts between Rs 15 lakhs and Rs 25 lakhs, applicants must additionally provide ITR for the last two years, a 12-month bank statement, and statements of all existing loans.

For amounts between Rs 25 lakhs and Rs 40 lakhs, all of the above are required along with proof of investments such as Fixed Deposits, Mutual Funds, or stock holdings, and property documents if available.

For loans above Rs 40 lakhs, a net worth certificate issued by a Chartered Accountant is mandatory. Additionally, an in-person interview with the Branch Manager is required before the application can be processed.

Agent Note: Incomplete documents are the single most common cause of loan processing delays — not outright rejections. Always collect all documents upfront before submitting the application. A missing bank statement for even one month causes an automatic processing hold. Verify each document individually before confirming completeness to the customer.

Section 3 — Home Loan: Eligibility, Terms & Documents

3.1 Who Can Apply for a Home Loan

Home loans at Bajaj Finance are available to resident Indian individuals, including joint applicants. Both salaried and self-employed applicants are eligible, subject to income verification and property assessment. Non-resident Indians are not covered under this product and must be directed to the separate NRI home loan scheme.

The eligible age range for salaried applicants is 21 to 65 years, measured at the time of loan maturity rather than at application. Self-employed applicants may apply between ages 25 and 70 years at maturity. Salaried applicants must earn a minimum net monthly income of Rs 25,000, while self-employed applicants must show a net annual profit of at least Rs 3 lakhs.

A CIBIL score of 700 or above is preferred for home loan approval. Applicants in the 650 to 699 band may be considered but will face higher interest rates and reduced Loan-to-Value ratios. Salaried applicants must have a minimum of two years of continuous service with their current employer. Self-employed applicants must demonstrate at least five years of business vintage.

The FOIR ceiling for home loans is 50 percent for most applicants. Government and defence employees enjoy a relaxed ceiling of 55 percent. Only residential property with a clear title and an approved layout is eligible as collateral. Properties without municipal or panchayat approval cannot be financed.

3.2 Loan Amount, Tenure and Interest Rate Structure

Home loans are available from Rs 5 lakhs to Rs 5 crores, subject to the applicant's eligibility and the property's Loan-to-Value limit. Tenures range from 5 to 30 years, but the loan must mature before the borrower turns 70 years of age.

Interest rates are offered in two variants. The floating rate option is linked to the RBI Repo Rate and is priced at Repo plus 2.0 to 3.5 percent depending on the applicant's CIBIL score and LTV. The fixed rate option locks in the rate for the first three years after which it converts to floating. Floating rate loans carry no prepayment charges. Fixed rate loans within the lock-in period attract a prepayment charge of 2 percent.

The processing fee for home loans is lower than for personal loans, ranging from 0.5 to 1.0 percent of the loan amount plus GST, with a minimum of Rs 5,000.

3.3 Loan-to-Value Limits — RBI Mandated Ceilings

The Loan-to-Value ratio, or LTV, defines the maximum percentage of the property's value that Bajaj Finance can lend. These limits are set by the Reserve Bank of India and cannot be exceeded under any circumstances, regardless of the borrower's profile or the property type.

For loans up to Rs 30 lakhs, the maximum LTV is 90 percent of the property's value. For loans between Rs 30 lakhs and Rs 75 lakhs, the ceiling drops to 80 percent. For loans above Rs 75 lakhs, only 75 percent of the property value can be financed. These ceilings apply equally to under-construction properties, where disbursement is made in stages linked to construction milestones.

Agent Note: LTV is always calculated on the lower of the registered sale value and the bank-approved property valuation — not on the higher figure. For example, a property with a market value of Rs 80 lakhs but a sale deed of Rs 60 lakhs will have LTV calculated on Rs 60 lakhs. The maximum loan at 80 percent LTV would be Rs 48 lakhs — not Rs 64 lakhs. Always use the valuation report from a

BFL-empanelled valuer as the basis for LTV calculations.

3.4 Co-Applicant Rules

A co-applicant is mandatory when the primary applicant's income alone does not satisfy the FOIR requirement, or when the property being financed is jointly owned. Co-applicants must be close family members. The preferred co-applicant is the spouse. Parents, earning children, and siblings may be accepted in limited cases.

When a co-applicant is added, both incomes are combined for eligibility calculation. Both parties must sign all loan documents. The CIBIL score of the co-applicant is also checked independently — a poor co-applicant score can cause the entire application to be rejected even if the primary applicant's profile is strong. Both applicants share equal liability for repayment, and any default is reported on both CIBIL profiles simultaneously. Non-earning co-applicants are permitted only to satisfy property ownership compliance — their income is not counted toward eligibility.

3.5 Home Loan Protection Plan

The Home Loan Protection Plan, or HLPP, is a reducing-balance life insurance policy that covers the outstanding loan amount in the event of the primary borrower's death. It is strongly recommended for all home loan customers but is not mandatory. Customers should be informed about it and encouraged to opt in.

Coverage reduces as the loan is repaid, always matching the outstanding principal at any point in time. The premium is a single payment made upfront, which can be added to the loan amount at the customer's request, marginally increasing the EMI. Eligibility is limited to applicants between 18 and 65 years of age. For loan amounts above Rs 50 lakhs, a medical examination may be required by the insurance company.

In the event of the borrower's death, the nominee contacts Bajaj Finance, and the insurance company directly settles the outstanding principal. This protects the family from inheriting the loan burden and ensures the property is not at risk. The HLPP premium is eligible for tax deduction under Section 80C up to Rs 1.5 lakhs per year.

Section 4 — Loan Rejection and Reapplication Policy

4.1 Primary Reasons for Loan Rejection

Understanding rejection reasons is critical for agents to correctly advise customers and set realistic expectations. Bajaj Finance's underwriting system applies both automated and manual checks, and rejection can occur at any stage of the process.

The most common reason for automatic rejection is a CIBIL score below 650. This is a hard system cutoff — no manual override is possible. Applicants in the 650 to 699 band are placed under manual review, with an approximate approval rate of 40 percent.

FOIR violation is the second most common rejection trigger. If the total of existing EMI commitments plus the proposed new EMI exceeds 50 percent of net monthly income, the system rejects the application automatically, regardless of the CIBIL score. Even a customer with a CIBIL score of 800 will be rejected if the FOIR threshold is breached.

Multiple hard enquiries on a customer's CIBIL report within a six-month window indicate credit-hungry behaviour and result in automatic rejection or enhanced scrutiny. More than three hard enquiries in six months is the threshold applied by the system.

Employment instability is flagged when an applicant has changed jobs within six months of application or has less than one year at their current employer. For self-employed applicants, fewer than three years of business vintage triggers rejection.

Income inconsistency is detected when bank account credits do not match the declared salary, when salary credits are irregular, or when there are large unexplained cash withdrawals. Any significant discrepancy between declared income and actual bank behavior leads to rejection or request for additional explanation.

Documentation mismatches, such as name discrepancies across Aadhaar, PAN, and salary slips, address mismatches, or expired documents, result in rejection. Any prior default in the last 36 months is also grounds for rejection. Accounts that show a status of Settled rather than Closed on the CIBIL report are treated as defaults and cause rejection.

4.2 Reapplication Waiting Periods and Conditions

Customers rejected on CIBIL grounds must wait a minimum of 90 days before reapplying. They are strongly advised to work on improving their score during this period. A maximum of two reapplications are permitted within any 12-month window for CIBIL-related rejections.

There is no mandatory waiting period for customers rejected due to FOIR. They may reapply immediately after a change in circumstances — either after closing an existing loan or after demonstrating a genuine increase in income.

Customers rejected due to documentation issues may reapply immediately with corrected documents. There is no waiting period in such cases.

Employment-related rejections require the customer to wait until they have completed at least one year with their current employer. For customers with multiple hard enquiries, the mandatory wait period is 180 days from the date of the last rejected application.

Section 5 — EMI Payment and Default Policy

5.1 How EMI Payments Work

The standard EMI due date at Bajaj Finance is the 5th of every month. Customers who prefer a different date may request the 1st or the 10th at the time of loan onboarding, subject to availability. Changing the

due date after disbursement requires a formal request and is not guaranteed.

EMI payments are collected exclusively via NACH mandate, which is an auto-debit instruction linked to the customer's registered bank account. Setting up the NACH mandate is mandatory for all loan customers and is completed within five working days of loan disbursement. The customer is required to sign the mandate form either digitally or physically at the branch.

If a customer needs to make a manual payment in any given month — for example, due to a temporary bank account change — they may do so via the Bajaj Finserv online portal, at any branch, or through NEFT transfer. However, the payment must reach before the 5th of the month to avoid late payment charges. Part payments are permitted only through the online portal, with a minimum amount of Rs 5,000. By default, part payments reduce the remaining tenure rather than the EMI amount.

5.2 Consequences of Default

When a customer misses their first EMI, the system triggers automated SMS and call reminders. A bounce charge of Rs 1,000 plus GST is applied on the day after the bounce. Late payment charges at 2 percent per month on the overdue amount also begin accruing from the first day of default.

If two consecutive EMIs are missed, the collections team initiates direct contact with the customer. The account is flagged internally, and CIBIL reporting begins with a 30 Days Past Due, or 30 DPD, classification. This reporting has a significant negative impact on the customer's credit score.

After three missed EMIs, a legal notice is dispatched and field visits by recovery agents are scheduled. CIBIL is updated to 60 DPD, reflecting a more serious delinquency status.

At six consecutive missed EMIs, the loan is classified as a Non-Performing Asset, or NPA. Legal proceedings are formally initiated at this stage. If the loan remains unpaid for 12 or more EMIs, it is written off internally, a legal suit is filed, and for secured loans, the collateral may be auctioned to recover dues.

5.3 EMI Holiday and Moratorium

Bajaj Finance offers a temporary EMI holiday facility for customers experiencing genuine short-term financial hardship. This facility is not a loan waiver. Interest continues to accrue during the holiday period at the contracted rate, and the accrued interest is added to the outstanding principal, effectively extending the loan tenure.

To be eligible for an EMI holiday, the customer must have made at least 12 EMI payments on the current loan without any existing default. Documented evidence of financial hardship is mandatory — acceptable documents include a termination letter, medical certificate for health emergencies, or similar official proof.

The maximum duration for a single EMI holiday request is three months. Over the entire lifetime of a loan, a maximum of two EMI holiday requests are permitted. The loan tenure is extended by the duration of the holiday, and the customer is notified in writing. All applications must be made in person at a branch — online requests are not accepted for this facility.

Section 6 — Business Loan: SME and MSME Products

6.1 Business Loan Product Overview

Bajaj Finance offers business loans to SMEs and MSMEs in two broad categories: unsecured loans up to Rs 50 lakhs and secured loans up to Rs 2 crores. Unsecured loans do not require any collateral, while secured loans require acceptable security as defined in Section 6.4.

For unsecured loans, the tenure ranges from 12 to 96 months. Secured business loans can extend up to 120 months. Interest rates are risk-priced and range from 14 to 24 percent per annum based on the applicant's CIBIL score and business vintage. The minimum annual turnover for unsecured loan eligibility is Rs 40 lakhs. For secured business loans, the minimum turnover threshold is Rs 1 crore.

Eligible business structures include Sole Proprietorships, Partnerships, Private Limited Companies, LLPs, and Public Limited Companies. The minimum business vintage is three years in profit for most sectors, extending to five years for manufacturing businesses.

6.2 Sector-Specific Rules

Bajaj Finance applies different eligibility criteria depending on the sector in which the applicant operates. This reflects the varying risk profiles and cash flow patterns across industries.

Trading and retail businesses require a minimum vintage of three years and may borrow up to Rs 50 lakhs without collateral. GST returns are mandatory for this sector. For loan amounts above Rs 25 lakhs in this segment, a stock audit is required before disbursement.

Service businesses including IT firms and consulting companies also require three years of vintage and are eligible for up to Rs 50 lakhs unsecured. For loans above Rs 20 lakhs in this segment, client contracts must be provided as supplementary income proof.

Manufacturing businesses face the strictest requirements: a minimum of five years of vintage, a cap of Rs 35 lakhs unsecured, mandatory factory registration certificate, and a valid pollution clearance certificate.

Healthcare businesses and clinics require three years of vintage and may borrow up to Rs 50 lakhs. A valid medical registration certificate is mandatory for all healthcare loan applications.

Real estate and construction businesses must have five years of vintage and face a lower unsecured cap of Rs 25 lakhs. RERA registration is mandatory, and applications in this sector receive enhanced scrutiny from the credit team.

Hospitality and restaurant businesses require three years of vintage but face the most restrictive unsecured cap of Rs 20 lakhs. A valid FSSAI food safety licence is required. This sector is classified as higher risk and receives enhanced verification.

6.3 Collateral Accepted for Secured Business Loans

For business loans above Rs 50 lakhs, collateral is mandatory. Bajaj Finance accepts immovable property in the form of residential or commercial real estate, provided the property is free of any encumbrance. The maximum LTV for property collateral is 60 percent.

Fixed Deposits are accepted as collateral. BFL-issued FDs are valued at 90 percent of face value, while third-party FDs from other banks are accepted at 80 percent. For manufacturing businesses specifically, machinery and equipment may be pledged at up to 50 percent of the depreciated book value as per the latest balance sheet.

Insurance policies with surrender value are also acceptable. LIC policies are preferred. The maximum collateral value for insurance policies is 80 percent of the surrender value at the time of pledging. For Private Limited companies borrowing above Rs 25 lakhs, a personal guarantee from all directors is mandatory regardless of the collateral provided. All collateral valuations must be conducted by a BFL-empanelled valuer, the cost of which is borne by the borrower. Valuations are valid for six months from the date of assessment.

6.4 Business Loan Rejection Triggers

Annual turnover below Rs 40 lakhs triggers automatic system rejection for all unsecured business loan applications. This threshold cannot be waived manually.

A mismatch of more than 20 percent between the income declared in the ITR and the turnover implied by GST returns triggers an investigation. Applications with ITR-GST mismatch are often rejected or placed on indefinite hold until the discrepancy is resolved.

Certain business sectors are classified as negative or high-risk industries and require special approval from the credit committee. These include real estate developers, chit funds, NBFCs, and jewellery traders.

A business with more than 60 percent of its transactions in cash is considered difficult to verify from an income standpoint and is subject to enhanced scrutiny or outright rejection. Any director or partner with a default in the last 36 months results in rejection of the entire business loan application.

Overleveraged businesses — where total existing business debt plus the proposed loan exceeds three times the annual turnover — will be rejected on grounds of over-indebtedness.

Agent Note: Always cross-check GST returns against bank credits for business loan applications. A customer with Rs 80 lakhs declared ITR income but only Rs 40 lakhs in annual bank credits will fail income verification. The ITR, GST returns, and bank statement must be internally consistent. Flag any discrepancy before submitting the application. The rejection rate for business loans is 40 percent higher when an ITR-GST mismatch is detected in pre-screening.

Section 7 — Gold Loan: Products and Process

7.1 Gold Loan Product Overview

Bajaj Finance gold loans are available for amounts ranging from Rs 5,000 to Rs 2 crores, depending on the weight and purity of the gold pledged. Gold of 18 karat to 24 karat purity is accepted. Gold below 18 karat is ineligible and cannot be financed under this product.

The Loan-to-Value ratio for gold loans is capped at 75 percent of the gold's current market value, as mandated by the RBI. This ceiling applies to all gold loan products without exception. Tenures range from 3 months to 24 months, with customers having the option of bullet repayment (principal and interest paid together at maturity) or monthly interest payments with principal at maturity.

Interest rates for gold loans range from 9.5 to 18 percent per annum. High-value loans above Rs 5 lakhs attract the more favourable rate band of 9.5 to 12 percent. Gold appraisal is conducted in-branch using an XRF machine, with results available within 15 minutes. Disbursal is completed on the same day, typically within 30 minutes of appraisal and KYC completion. Pledged gold is stored in bank-grade vaults that are fully insured and monitored by 24-hour CCTV surveillance.

7.2 Gold Loan Foreclosure Policy

Gold loan foreclosure refers to early closure of the loan before the completion of the agreed tenure. This is the most frequently raised query from gold loan customers, so agents must be completely clear on the applicable charges.

If the loan is closed within the first three months, a foreclosure charge of 2 percent on the outstanding principal plus all accrued interest applies. A branch visit is mandatory for this closure, and the customer must present the original pledge receipt.

For loans closed between three and six months after disbursement, the charge reduces to 2 percent on the outstanding principal only, with no accrued interest component. For closures between six and twelve months, the charge further reduces to 1 percent of the outstanding principal. After 12 months, there is no foreclosure charge — the customer pays only the outstanding principal plus interest accrued to date. For all closures, a branch visit is required and the NOC is issued within 30 minutes.

7.3 Gold Auction Policy

If a customer fails to repay a gold loan or renew it at maturity, Bajaj Finance sends a formal written notice. If repayment or renewal does not occur within 30 days of this notice, auction proceedings are initiated. The auction recovers the outstanding principal, accrued interest, and any applicable charges. If the auction proceeds exceed the total outstanding amount, the surplus is returned to the customer within 7 working days of the auction date.

Section 8 — CIBIL Score: Impact and Reporting Policy

8.1 How Bajaj Finance Reports to Credit Bureaus

Bajaj Finance reports loan data to all four major credit bureaus operating in India: TransUnion CIBIL, Experian, Equifax, and CRIF High Mark. Reporting is done monthly, on the 7th of every month, covering

the previous month's data. This includes loan sanction events, monthly EMI payment status, defaults, loan closures, and settlements.

Regular and timely EMI payments generate positive reporting, which can improve a customer's CIBIL score by 5 to 10 points per month depending on the bureau's scoring algorithm.

When a customer applies for a loan, a hard enquiry is generated on their credit report. Hard enquiries typically result in a drop of 5 to 10 points per enquiry and remain visible on the credit report for 24 months. Internal credit checks by Bajaj Finance for existing customer reviews generate soft enquiries, which do not affect the CIBIL score.

8.2 Negative Events and Their Score Impact

A 30-day overdue event reduces a customer's CIBIL score by 30 to 50 points. A 60-day overdue event causes a drop of 50 to 80 points. A 90-day overdue event results in a loss of 80 to 100 points. All three categories of delinquency remain on the credit report for seven years.

A loan settlement — where the bank accepts a lower amount than the full outstanding — reduces the score by 100 to 150 points and stays on the report for seven years, displaying as 'Settled' rather than 'Closed'. This distinction is critical: a Settled account is treated as a default by most lenders and will cause rejection during future loan applications.

A write-off results in the most severe score impact, reducing the CIBIL score by 150 to 200 points. It remains on the report for seven years and is accompanied by a legal action record. In contrast, a loan that has been fully repaid and properly closed adds 20 to 40 points to the score and creates a permanent positive record showing the account status as Closed.

8.3 CIBIL Dispute Resolution Process

If a customer believes there is an error on their CIBIL report — for example, a default reported in error or a closed loan still showing as active — they must raise a dispute directly on the CIBIL website at www.cibil.com. Once the dispute is filed, Bajaj Finance is notified within three business days.

The Bajaj Finance internal team reviews the dispute within 15 working days. If the dispute is found to be valid, a correction is reported to all four credit bureaus simultaneously, and the customer is informed in writing. The end-to-end resolution typically takes 30 to 45 working days from the date of filing.

Agent Note: Do not promise customers specific score improvements or timelines. Your role is to direct them to the CIBIL dispute portal and log the complaint in the CRM. Score changes are determined entirely by the bureaus and are outside Bajaj Finance's direct control.

Section 9 — Customer Grievance Redressal Policy

9.1 Complaint Channels and Resolution SLAs

Bajaj Finance operates a three-tier grievance redressal structure. The first level, or L1, covers all initial complaints through four channels. The helpdesk can be reached at the toll-free number 1800-103-3535, available Monday to Saturday from 8 AM to 8 PM. L1 helpdesk complaints are resolved within 3 working days.

Email complaints sent to customercare@bajajfinserv.in receive an acknowledgement within 24 hours and must be resolved within 5 working days. Branch visits generate a CRM ticket with a 3 working day resolution SLA. The online portal at www.bajajfinserv.in/contact is available 24 hours a day and carries a 5 working day resolution timeline.

If the L1 response is unsatisfactory, the customer may escalate to L2 by writing to nodalofficer@bajajfinserv.in. The Nodal Officer must respond within 7 working days. If the complaint remains unresolved after 30 days from the original filing, the customer is entitled to approach the RBI Banking Ombudsman, which constitutes the L3 or final escalation tier.

9.2 Common Service Request Timelines

A No Objection Certificate following full loan closure is issued within 7 working days and is provided in both digital and physical form. The lien release for property loans takes 7 working days, while for gold loans it is completed within 1 working day.

Loan statements are available instantly through the mobile app and online portal. Requests at the branch are fulfilled within 1 working day. Interest certificates for income tax purposes are available on the portal and take up to 2 working days at the branch.

Repayment schedules are available immediately on the portal. Branch copies take 1 working day. Duplicate NOCs, for customers who have misplaced their original, carry a charge of Rs 500 plus GST and are issued within 7 working days.

Section 10 — Loan Renewal and Top-Up Policy

10.1 Who Is Eligible for Loan Renewal

Loan renewal, commonly referred to as a top-up loan, allows existing Bajaj Finance customers to borrow additional funds on top of their current outstanding loan. All eligibility conditions must be satisfied simultaneously — partial eligibility is not sufficient.

The customer must have an internal repayment score above 700. This score is calculated by Bajaj Finance's systems based on the customer's payment history on the current loan and is separate from the external CIBIL score. There must be no defaults in the last 12 months, and no EMI bounces in the last 6 months.

Renewal is available only in Tier 1 and Tier 2 cities. Customers in rural areas are not eligible for top-up loans and must apply for a fresh loan if they need additional credit. The customer must have paid a minimum of 6 EMIs on the existing loan before a renewal application can be submitted. Additionally,

either at least 12 months must remain on the current loan, or the renewal is applied at the time of loan closure.

10.2 Top-Up Amount Limits

The maximum top-up amount depends on both the customer's employment type and the city tier in which they are located. Salaried customers in Tier 1 cities may borrow up to Rs 1 lakh above their existing outstanding balance. In Tier 2 cities, this limit reduces to Rs 75,000.

Self-employed customers face lower top-up limits due to the higher income variability in this segment. In Tier 1 cities, self-employed customers may borrow up to Rs 50,000 above their existing outstanding. In Tier 2 cities, the cap is Rs 30,000. Rural customers of any employment type are not eligible for renewal and must submit a fresh loan application.

10.3 Gold Loan Renewal Process

Gold loan renewal at maturity requires the pledged gold to be re-appraised using the XRF machine at the branch. The new loan is issued at the LTV applicable on the renewal date and carries the prevailing interest rate at that time. Customers may opt for a partial renewal by repaying a minimum of 10 percent of the outstanding amount and renewing the remaining balance.

A processing fee of Rs 500 plus GST applies to all gold loan renewals. If the original KYC documents submitted at the time of initial pledging have expired — for example, an Aadhaar or PAN that has been reissued — fresh KYC documents must be provided at the time of renewal. The gold price used for re-appraisal is the market rate on the actual renewal date.

This document covers all 10 policy areas of the Bajaj Finance Helpdesk Knowledge Base in prose format. This edition is optimised for RAG ingestion with RecursiveCharacterTextSplitter. For structured table lookups (rate slabs, LTV limits, charge schedules), refer to the companion Policy Reference Document v4.0 with table-aware chunking.